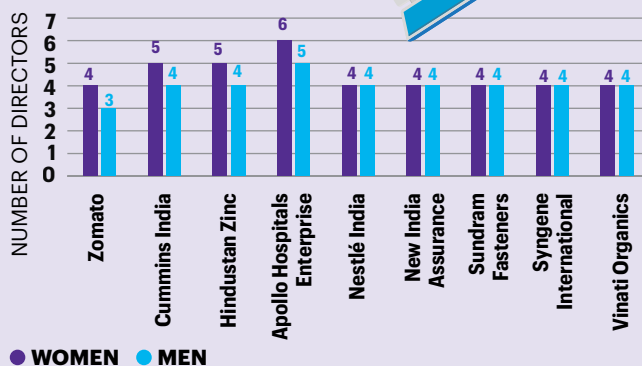
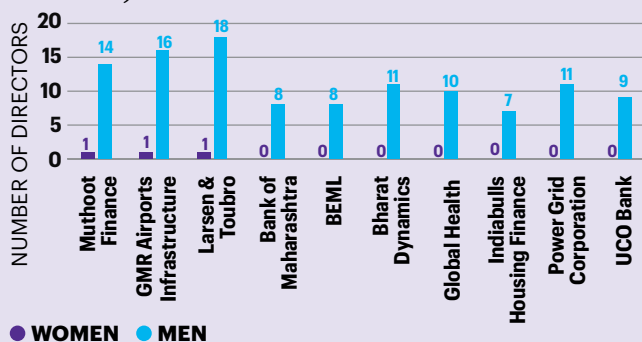


The Good...



...and, the Bad



► Only nine firms in the Nifty 500 have at least 50 per cent women on their boards

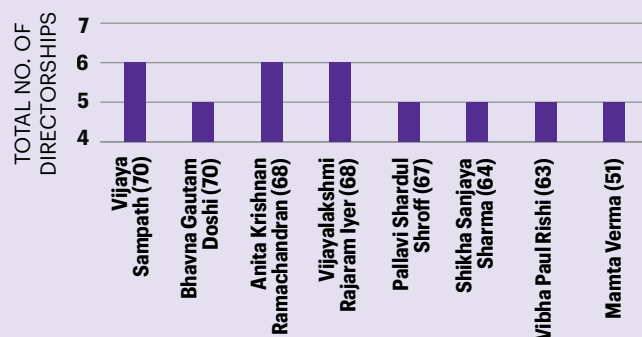
► PSUs, however, fare poorly in terms of women's representation on their boards

NIFTY 500 FIRMS WITH THE BEST AND WORST WOMEN'S REPRESENTATION ON BOARDS; DATA AS OF OCTOBER 26, 2023 **SOURCE** PRIMEINFOBASE.COM

Working Overtime

► Women with the most directorships are mostly above the age of 60

► As many as three women hold six directorships each in the Nifty 500 companies



FIGURES IN BRACKETS INDICATE THE AGE OF WOMEN WITH THE MOST DIRECTORSHIPS; DATA FOR NIFTY 500 COMPANIES; **SOURCE** PRIMEINFOBASE.COM

their boards. In India, there is still a lot of who the Chairman knows and wants on the board,” says Bali. “Companies advertise for all other important positions. Have you ever seen any advertisement for board positions seeking talent from the open market?” asks Manoj K. Raut, CEO & Secretary General of the Institute of Directors, India. The organisation trains, certifies, and mentors directors, and helps them get empanelled on different boards.

Vohra of IIMA, who serves as independent director herself and trains corporates in leadership, says an Indian board places a premium on knowing the person being selected because they are trusted with all kinds of information. “It is seen as a high cost to the company when the woman being selected is unknown to their network. That is why so few women keep getting circulated around boards.” When that is the case, how much meaningful contribution can the person in question make for the company's growth and strategy? Very little, says Raut. “Once you are on the board, you will be on several committees. And those meetings can go on for long. Nothing can be finalised overnight.”

Speaking of committees, women board members are traditionally limited to leadership positions in Grievance and CSR committees, while the Nomination and Remuneration Committee (NRC) and Audit Committee, which are perceived as important, are customarily reserved for men. But here, too, the EY